

Use Case-Led Style Guide for a Solutions Library

The naming, writing, and diagram standards for a cloud solutions library: implementation guides, architecture diagrams, and solution pages written by 300+ solutions architects and specialists. Internal tools, names, and approval paths are removed. The rules themselves are unchanged.

THE ONE RULE It is product information, not marketing copy. A reader who is not technical should be able to tell from one page whether a solution fits their organization. Every rule in this guide serves that test.

300+

contributors writing to one standard

2M+

monthly page views on the library

6 → 2 wks

time to publish after the rules moved into the pipeline

9 wks

editorial backlog cleared

FOUR PRINCIPLES

01 Plain Use the words a customer types into a search engine. Define a term or drop it.	02 Brief Pay for every word. 25 words or fewer per sentence. The point goes first.	03 Specific Name the component, the number, and the source. No weasel words or unsourced superlatives.	04 Usable Write for people who skim. Lists over blocks, real headings, descriptive links.
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HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Find the section for the asset you are writing. Then keep section 08 open while you write.

01 Taxonomy. The four-level model p2	06 Solution pages and diagrams p6
02 Naming formats. Titles and limits p2	07 Steps, pillars, and guides p7
03 Naming rules. Solution areas and use cases p3	08 Writing standards p8
04 Naming rules. Solutions, guidance, partners p4	09 Grammar and punctuation p9
05 Descriptions. Three formulas p5	→ How it runs, and live examples p9

WHO IT SERVES

Solutions architects and specialists who build architectures and write the content that explains them. Most are engineers first and writers second. That is why every rule here comes with a correct and an incorrect example: contributors learn faster by comparing two versions than by reading a principle.

The library holds four solution types: platform services, packaged solutions, partner solutions, and guidance. Each one maps to a use case. Each use case sits in a solution area, and each solution area sits in a domain. Name from the top down: the use case name should fit its solution area, and the solution area should reflect its domain.

LEVEL 1 Domain An industry or a technology field. ----- Financial Services	LEVEL 2 Solution area Related use cases for one buyer or one technology category. ----- Trade Lifecycle Modernization	LEVEL 3 Use case One customer problem or opportunity. ----- Regulatory Reporting	LEVEL 4 Solution type The asset: solution, guidance, partner offer, or service. ----- Guidance for Regulatory Reporting on Northwind
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Industry domains can add a sub-domain for a customer segment, such as Financial Services > Capital Markets.

02 Naming formats

TITLES ARE SEARCH TERMS

Customers were confused about what counts as a "solution," because many assets used the word. One naming system fixed that. Use these formats for every new title.

CONTENT TYPE	FORMAT	LIMIT	EXAMPLES
Solution area	Nouns for a set of related use cases. Industry areas align to a business function. Technology areas align to a technical category.	~50 chars	Privacy-Enhanced Data Collaboration Language Understanding
Use case	Nouns for the customer problem or opportunity	~50 chars	Customer 360 Profiles Data Clean Rooms
Solution	[Use Case] on Northwind or [Use Case] with/for [Service]. With a third party: [Use Case] for [Third Party] on Northwind	~55 chars	Automated Data Analytics on Northwind Data Analytics for Acme on Northwind
Guidance	Guidance for [Use Case] on Northwind or using/with [Service]. Extra room for the required words.	~70 chars	Guidance for Contextual Intelligence for Advertising on Northwind
Partner	The partner names its own offer. Suggested patterns: [Product], [Product] [Use Case], [Use Case] with [Product], [Product] for [Service]	Partner's call	Edit in the Cloud with Acme

EVERY TITLE

- 01 Plain, descriptive nouns. No hype or claims you cannot prove.
- 02 Title case. "And," never an ampersand.
- 03 No slashes or dashes.
- 04 One form of an acronym. Introduce the other in the first sentence of the page.
- 05 Check search volume before you pick between two terms.

WHY LIMITS MATTER

Titles render on library cards, search results, and navigation. Past about 50 characters they wrap or truncate, and the words that get cut are usually the ones a customer searched for. Limits exclude spaces unless the rule says otherwise.

SOLUTION AREAS

01 Broader than a use case

A set of related priority workloads. Never shares a name with one of its use cases.

✓ **CORRECT**

Financial Services > Trade Lifecycle Modernization

Right level. Narrower names become its use cases.

✗ **INCORRECT**

Financial Services > Regulatory Reporting
Too granular. This is a use case.

02 One owner or one category

Industry areas map to one cost center with one buyer. Technology areas map to one category.

✓ **CORRECT**

Manufacturing > Engineering and Design
Owned by the VP of Engineering.

✗ **INCORRECT**

Finance, IT, and Core Systems
Three cost centers in one name.

03 Customer language, unbranded

Platform-agnostic terms a customer would use. No code names or "frameworks."

✓ **CORRECT**

Clinical Drug Development

✗ **INCORRECT**

Project Lind
An internal code word no customer knows.

04 Say what problems it solves

Industry areas name the business concern, not a generic workload.

✓ **CORRECT**

Financial Services > Data Risk and Analytics

✗ **INCORRECT**

Generative AI · Migrations · IT Systems
Too broad to signal a business problem.

05 Segments are sub-domains

A slice of customers within an industry is not a solution area.

✓ **CORRECT**

Financial Services > *sub-domain* Capital Markets

✗ **INCORRECT**

Financial Services > *solution area* Capital Markets

USE CASES

01 The problem, not the product

Center what the customer solves.

✓ **CORRECT**

Document Processing

✗ **INCORRECT**

Object Storage for Document Storage

02 Industry terms, no internal terms

Never repeat a use case across areas in one domain. Pick the primary buyer.

✓ **CORRECT**

Satellite Communications

✗ **INCORRECT**

Day One Innovation for Low Earth Orbit Communications
Internal slogan. Nobody searches for it.

03 Descriptive, not persuasive

No "world-class," "next-generation," or "2.0."

✓ **CORRECT**

Website Performance and Security

✗ **INCORRECT**

100% Uptime Website Performance & World-class Security
Unprovable claim, hyperbole, ampersand.

04 Nouns, third person, title case

"And," not "&." No slashes or dashes.

✓ **CORRECT**

Enterprise Reporting and Analytics

✗ **INCORRECT**

Creating Enterprise Reports and Analyzing Data
Verbs describe actions, not problems.

05 Plural when you can

If both forms work, choose the plural.

✓ **CORRECT**

Sustainable Buildings

✗ **INCORRECT**

Sustainable Building

PACKAGED SOLUTIONS

01 A specific use case or outcome

Easy to find, and named for what deploying it gets you.

✓ **CORRECT**

Automated Security Response on Northwind

✗ **INCORRECT**

Security on Northwind
A topic, not a problem.

02 Don't sound like a service

Avoid words that imply a product: engine, automator, core, maker, registry, detector.

✓ **CORRECT**

Media Insights on Northwind

✗ **INCORRECT**

Northwind Media Insights Engine

03 No platform brand up front

A brand prefix makes a solution read like an official service. It needs executive sign-off.

✓ **CORRECT**

Security Automations for Northwind Firewall

✗ **INCORRECT**

Northwind Security Automations

04 Keep the product's own name

A platform-owned solution that runs a third-party product uses that product's name.

✓ **CORRECT**

Acme Server for Northwind

✗ **INCORRECT**

Running the Server for Acme on the Northwind Cloud

05 One solution, one name

Multiple deployment options get descriptions, not names.

✓ **CORRECT**

Live Streaming on Northwind
One name, two reference architectures.

✗ **INCORRECT**

Live Streaming on Northwind and Live Streaming on Northwind with Object Storage

06 One form of an acronym

No parentheses in titles.

✓ **CORRECT**

IoT Device Simulator

✗ **INCORRECT**

Protecting Workloads from Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) Attacks

GUIDANCE

01 The full format

Starts with "Guidance for," ends with the platform or service.

✓ **CORRECT**

Guidance for Baseline Security Assessment on Northwind

✗ **INCORRECT**

Baseline Security Assessment

02 The right format is not enough

It still needs a specific use case.

✓ **CORRECT**

Guidance for Near Real-Time Fraud Detection on Northwind

✗ **INCORRECT**

Guidance for Security on Northwind

03 Concise for search

Descriptive words, nothing extra. One acronym form.

✓ **CORRECT**

Guidance for Building an Agricultural Sensor Network using IoT

✗ **INCORRECT**

Guidance for Securing Workloads with Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) on Northwind

PARTNER OFFERS

Partners own and name their offers. Pick a name a buyer could identify on sight: the brand or manufacturer, in title case, with no hype. Putting the platform's brand on a partner offer ("on Northwind," "powered by Northwind") is reserved for strategic partners and needs executive approval.

Descriptions are objective and informative, never persuasive. Write for a CIO and a developer at once, at a 100 to 200 technical level. Use the SEO terms from your marketing lead.

A · USE CASE DESCRIPTION · 75–80 WORDS MAX

1–2 SENTENCES · CHALLENGE The problem or opportunity, without talking down to the reader.	1 SENTENCE · APPROACH "[Use case] solutions on Northwind help customers..."	1–2 SENTENCES · BENEFIT The business outcome. Stay out of the technical weeds.
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Banks traditionally use legacy systems for core banking applications, such as lending, payments, and deposits. However, these systems are monolithic, expensive, and lack open architecture, which slows the bank's response to market demands. Using Core Banking System Modernization solutions on Northwind, banks can replace these costly systems with core applications based on open APIs. With these solutions, banks can reduce system costs, improve their agility, and find new ways to serve their customers.

Financial Services > Banking > Core Banking System Modernization · 76 words

LEAVE OUT

- 01 Customer names, even if you think they would agree
- 02 Condescension ("Customers don't understand how to...")
- 03 Promises or grand statements about results
- 04 Calls to action ("Click to deploy...")
- 05 Jargon

B · SOLUTION AREA DESCRIPTION · 255 CHARS MAX

Solutions to help [persona] achieve [benefits]

Business areas name a business leader (CMO, VP of Supply Chain). Technical areas name a technical leader (CTO, VP of Engineering).

Solutions to enable the chief technology officer to create flexible, remote studios and deploy GPU-powered workstations, allowing artists and designers to work on multiple large files in the cloud.

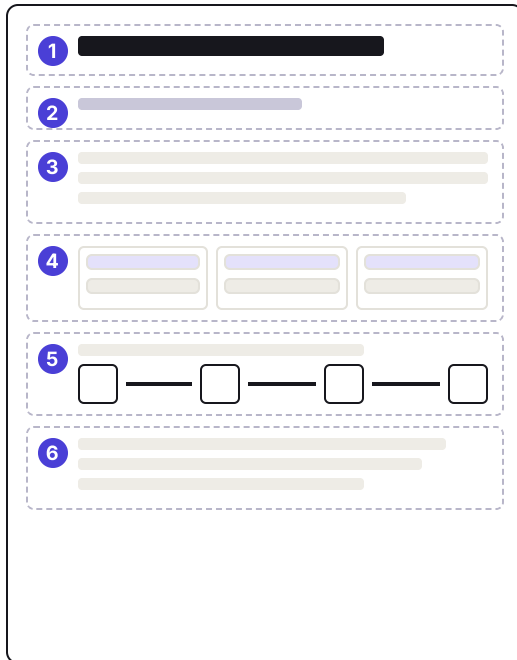
Games > Cloud Game Development · 199 characters

C · GUIDANCE DESCRIPTION · CUSTOMER-CENTRIC, FOUR MOVES

01 · OPEN "This Guidance demonstrates..." plus the value to the customer, not the service.	02 · COMPONENTS What the architecture includes, in terms the target user recognizes.	03 · BENEFITS Security, scale, cost, or operations, tied to this use case.	04 · FLEXIBILITY How to extend it for the customer's own needs.
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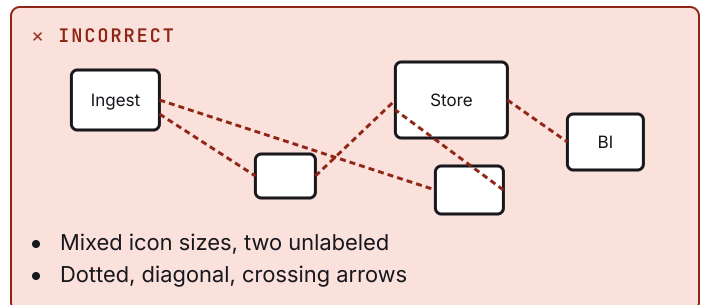
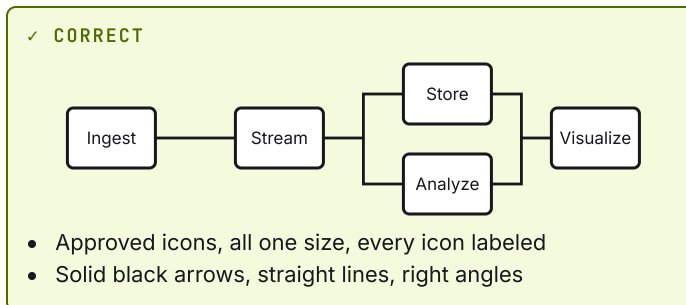
This Guidance demonstrates how to deploy a resilient video discovery server architecture within a private network. The included infrastructure template provisions a pair of compute instances across two availability zones, then downloads and installs the discovery software. This foundation lets you add live video transport to your environment and supports broadcast workflows such as live cloud production. The Guidance is extensible, so you can add components or connect other services as your workflows change.

Solution pages are deeply technical, so they need extra care to stay readable. Readers skim and scan. Put the important point in the first sentence of each paragraph, break text into lists, and keep each component within its limit.



COMPONENT	RULE	LIMIT
1 Title	Solution naming format	~55 chars
2 Short description	The subhead. High-level benefits for search.	70 chars
3 Overview	Business value for technical and non-technical readers. No solution name, no links.	50-150 words
4 Benefits	Header plus support. No links.	2-4 • 20-40 chars • 50 words
5 Architecture	Intro describes the architecture only. White-background PNG or SVG, no step text in the image.	1 diagram
6 Steps	Short, descriptive, one action each	10-20 words

ARCHITECTURE DIAGRAMS



BUILD RULES

- 01 Use the approved template and the current icon set only.
- 02 Don't crop, flip, rotate, or reshape icons.
- 03 Labels fit on two lines, never break mid-word, 9 pt minimum. The brand stays on the same line as the service name.
- 04 Short names in the diagram. Long names in the steps.
- 05 Flow left to right, top to bottom, or clockwise.
- 06 No third-party logos without written legal approval.

CHECKLIST BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

- ☐ Template and approved icons used
- ☐ All icons the same size
- ☐ Every icon labeled, including gateways and endpoints
- ☐ Perpendicular arrows, none crossing
- ☐ Every service in the diagram appears in the steps
- ☐ Third-party approvals on file
- ☐ File named for the title, minus "Guidance for"

NARRATIVE STEPS

01 Present tense, imperative

Commands. Never "will."

✓ CORRECT

Create the database table.

✗ INCORRECT

You will create the database table.

02 Active voice

Name the actor. Cut "is used."

✓ CORRECT

Capture data from social media feeds.
The streaming service sends it to the cloud.

✗ INCORRECT

The streaming service is used to send social media data to the cloud.

03 Name the reader

"You" if the reader is the user.
Otherwise a role, never "users."

✓ CORRECT

Data scientists analyze data from the stream.

✗ INCORRECT

Users analyze data from the stream.

Also: define acronyms at first mention. Bold and link the full service name at first mention, then use the short name in bold.

ARCHITECTURE PILLARS · ANSWER WHAT, HOW, AND WHY FOR EACH OF SIX PILLARS

CONTRIBUTOR DRAFT · COST OPTIMIZATION		AFTER THE WRITERS' EDIT
WHAT	Data integration service, key-value database	Integration jobs run in the largest batch size allowed to minimize transaction costs. The database's time-to-live (TTL) setting deletes expired items at an interval you set, without consuming write capacity, so you don't pay to store data you no longer need.
HOW	Integration jobs run in the largest batch size allowed. A time-to-live (TTL) setting deletes expired items without consuming write capacity.	
WHY	Large batches minimize transaction costs. TTL means you don't pay to store data you no longer need.	
		Three answers become one paragraph. Each fact connects to its benefit, and the "why" never stands alone.

01 Reference specific components in this architecture.

02 Give each pillar its own answer. Cost, performance, and sustainability can't all be "it scales."

03 Don't copy answers from past guidance.

01 Cut anything true of every architecture ("serverless optimizes resources").

02 Describe what exists today. No future or aspirational features.

03 Tie every answer to a business or technical benefit.

IMPLEMENTATION GUIDES · FLEXIBLE, BUT STRUCTURED

Structure

Title matches the diagram. A summary answers who it helps, what it does, and why it exists. Sentence case for H2 and below. No stacked headings. Caption every table and figure.

Procedures

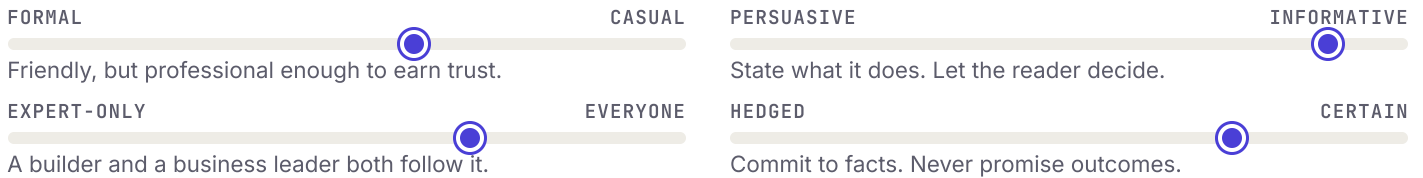
Break a workflow into 7 to 10 steps, with each user decision as its own step. About 15 words per sentence, 25 max. Bold UI terms. No caps or italics for emphasis.

Nesting

Numbers, then lowercase letters, then roman numerals. Combine short paths with angle brackets: **Settings** > **Roles** > **Create role**. End with revisions and contributor names.

The audience runs from developers to CIOs to curious readers, and all of them are busy. Write at an 8th-grade reading level. Research shows it helps adults read faster and retain more. That doesn't mean simpler ideas. It means the ideas cost less effort to understand.

VOICE: DIRECT, INFORMATIVE, APPROACHABLE



Jargon

Say what you mean or define it. "Deep dive," "out-of-the-box," and "purpose-built" are all jargon.

✓ CORRECT

The dashboards let your team review the same data at once, so they can make informed decisions toward team goals.

✗ INCORRECT

The dashboards provide a single pane of glass to help you dive deep and move the needle.

Conciseness

Imagine you pay for each word. "I emailed you," not "I wrote up an email and sent it."

✓ CORRECT

Companies of all sizes want to predict future demand so they can improve the customer experience and increase revenue.

✗ INCORRECT

Big, medium, and small companies want to not only understand what their customers are looking for but also what they really need...

Weasel words

Vague words hide the claim.

✓ CORRECT

Object storage supports variable access patterns. Storage classes set cost by access frequency: daily, monthly, or yearly.

✗ INCORRECT

Object storage would help with many of your challenges. You could use some features to store much of your data.

Comparatives

Better, faster, easier: than what?

✓ CORRECT

This service returns results faster than comparable on-premises services.

✗ INCORRECT

This service gives you faster results.

Superlatives

Cite a published source, or cut the claim.

✓ CORRECT

According to a 2022 industry report, migration cut customer costs by 22% and raised administrator productivity by 66%.

✗ INCORRECT

Northwind is the cheapest cloud option with the best performance.

Active voice

Subject, verb, object. "We recommend," not "it is recommended."

✓ CORRECT

The streaming service sends data from social media feeds to the cloud.

✗ INCORRECT

Data is captured from social media feeds and sent to the cloud.

FLAG ON SIGHT

should could would might some many most
few often best fastest largest always
never guarantee world-class next-generation

CLAIM CAREFULLY

INSTEAD OF

WRITE

ensure

help ensure, confirm, verify

real time

near real time, or the measured speed

legacy (their systems)

traditional, outdated, manual

Point of view

"You" for the reader. "We" for the company.

Sentences

25 words max. One space after a period.

Capitalization

Only proper nouns, title-case headings, and sentence starts.

Dates

October 1, 2022 or 2022-10-01. Never 10/01/2022 or "1st."

Lists

Bullets for items, numbers for steps. Introduce every list with a colon.

Acronyms

Define at first mention, then abbreviate. Titles get one form only.

Commas

Serial comma always. Comma before a conjunction joining two clauses, and after an intro phrase.

Semicolons

Avoid them. Write two sentences.

Colons

Lowercase after one unless a full sentence follows.

Slashes

OK in I/O, CI/CD, paths. Never and/or or add/edit.

Ranges

En dash, no spaces: August 13–15.

Symbols

No ampersands in body text. Straight apostrophes only.

SKIP THE LATIN

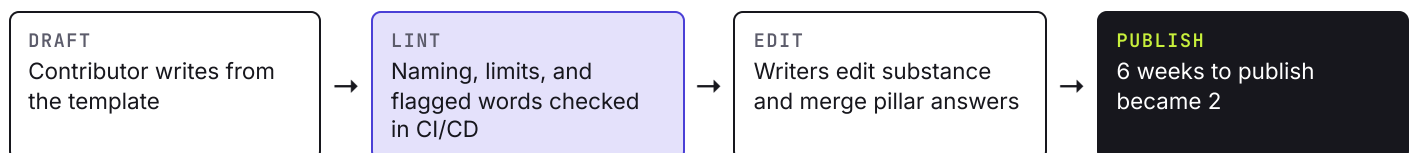
DON'T USE	USE INSTEAD
e.g.	for example, such as
i.e.	that is, specifically
etc.	and so on, or cut it
ad hoc	one-time, when required
per	for, for each

ACCESSIBILITY AND INCLUSION

- 01 Descriptive link text, never "here." Device-neutral verbs: "choose," not "click."
- 02 Real heading levels. Bold is not a heading. Headers on every table.
- 03 "Preceding" and "following," not "above" and "below."
- 04 Simple images, even white padding, sentence-case labels.
- 05 Primary/replica, allowlist/denylist. No ableist or sexist terms.

How the guide runs

FROM DOCUMENT TO SYSTEM



Contributors get support through writer office hours and 1:1 developmental reviews. The guide also became the source for an LLM knowledge base built with engineering, which improved the relevance of AI-generated responses by 25% in early testing.

SEE IT IN PRODUCTION

CONTENT STRATEGY

AWS Solutions Library

The library this guide governs. The taxonomy, naming formats, and page components in this guide are live here.

aws.amazon.com/solutions

LAUNCH DOCUMENTATION

Amazon Aurora DSQL User Guide

GA launch documentation for AWS's first multi-Region serverless SQL database, written to the same standards.

docs.aws.amazon.com/aurora-dsql